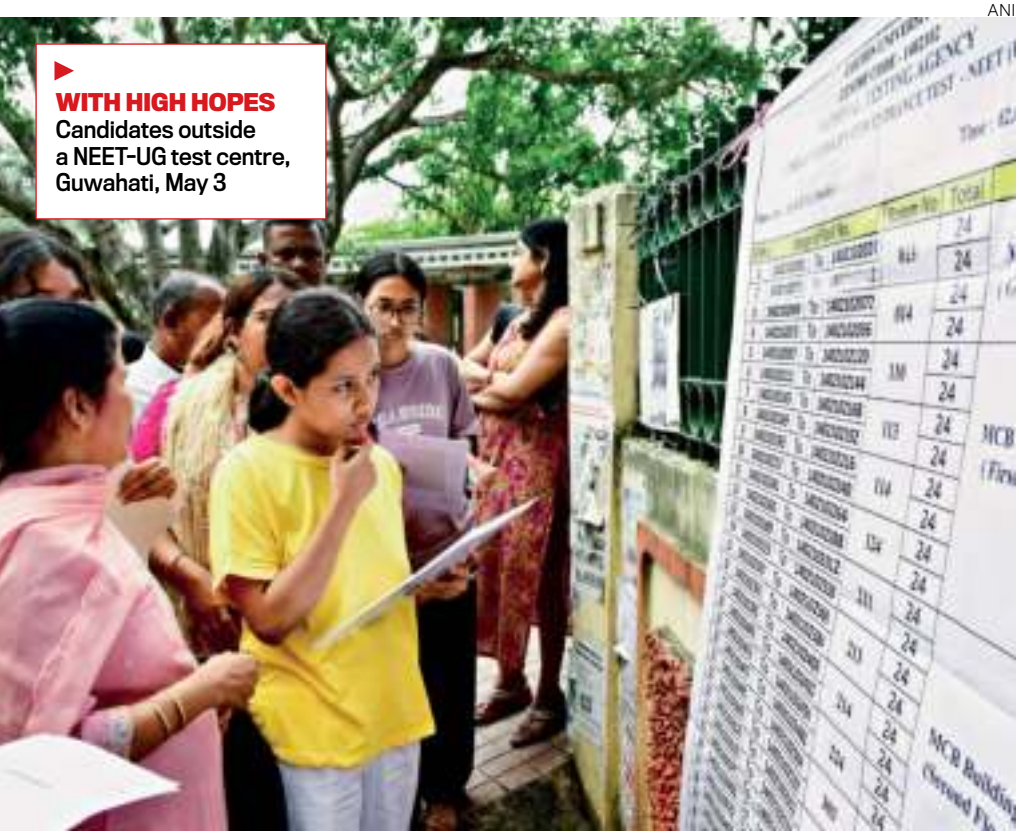
ANI



**WITH HIGH HOPES**
Candidates outside a NEET-UG test centre, Guwahati, May 3

**5** For tests with more than 200,000 registered candidates, multi-session testing should be conducted over several days or weeks, backed by a transparent, pre-declared normalisation method

**Status: Not done for NEET-UG**

**6** The NEET-UG could move to a multi-stage model, with clearly defined thresholds, scoring objectives, ranking method and number of attempts, potentially reducing the risk of one leaked paper destroying the entire process

**Status: Not done**

**7** From 2026, conduct a hybrid 'computer-assisted secure pen-and-paper test', where encrypted papers reach test centres digitally and are printed there, cutting out the leak-prone printing, storage, transport chain

**Status: Not done**

**8** On the lines of DigiYatra, implement a multi-stage candidate authentication using Aadhaar, biometrics and AI-driven data analytics. This will ensure that only genuine candidates take the test, weeding out impersonators

**Status: Mostly done**

**9** Create vetted expert pools, secure question-setting and formatting systems, controlled-access confidential operations, and robust encryption with tamper-resistant delivery from command centres to test centres

**Status: Not done**

**10** There should be at least one secure standardised testing centre in almost every district, a target of 1,000 secure centres in reputed government institutes, mobile testing centres for remote regions such as the Northeast, and eventually a public NTA testing platform that can support computer-based tests (CBT) and future computer-adaptive testing

**Status: Mostly done**



**"Each time one loophole is fixed, another appears. That is why institutions need people with memory, expertise and the ability to learn from failure. Those trying to rig the system are experienced too"**

*— **Vineet Joshi,** Secretary, Department of Higher Education*

conceded "there was a breach somewhere in the chain of command". NTA director-general Abhishek Singh, who took charge a month before the NEET-UG exam, attributes the failure to a trust that had turned into a blind spot. "Many of the translators had been there for six or seven years," he says. "The organisation had developed trust in them. But, in such examinations, you must follow a zero-trust architecture." Other NTA sources say the translation was done by hand, and the accused probably made multiple copies and smuggled out the papers, though the CBI has yet to establish exactly how.

As student groups, including Sangh affiliate Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad, erupted in protest, Opposition parties sharpened their attack on the government. Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi called NEET an "auction", alleging that questions were sold on WhatsApp, and said the Congress would not rest till Pradhan resigned and a foolproof system put in place.